

A deadly gang

They've got a PhD in pain and a Masters in disaster. *Quake* masters and quad gods—that's The Unholy Alliance in a nutshell

SRIRAM SHARMA

Saturday afternoon. Semi-finals at the *Counter-Strike* (CS) tourney at Surf's Up. In progress is one of the most exciting CS games ever played. The map is de_dust. (TUA) Wile is the last man standing from the Terrorists camp. All the CTs (Counter-Terrorists) are storming the bomb defusal spot. Wile snipes a CT 100 feet away, switches to his pistol, guns down another CT at close range, grabs his assault rifle, and shoots another CT with it. He throws the rifle and picks his AWM back again to snipe another CT. Four dead bodies in less than three seconds. Terrorists win.

No other gaming clan elicits so much fear, admiration and respect as TUA—The Unholy

every night, the rest of Kawabonka quickly realised what TUA was all about. They were beating the living daylight out of the opposition and they were here to stay. A few members of the initial line-up dropped out and new members came in. Today the TUA stands as Wile (Dhruv Parpia, Pune), JBI (Rahul Rohira, Mumbai), Strider (Siddharth Seth, Delhi), Fragbait (Sameer Shetty, Mumbai), CyAnide (Prashanth Raju, Chennai), Mad_Toothbrush (Ram Balmur, Pune), Ricky (Ricky Kapur, Delhi).

Geographically far apart, the members come together at kawabonka.com to practice. And each one brings along his own flavour. Wile used to lead 'Massive Destruction', the best *Quake III* CTF clan in the world while he was in the US. Mad_Toothbrush is another *Quake* master, who gets calls to join foreign clans every time he cleans base with a 150 ping on foreign servers. A natural leader, he comes up with the TUA calls and strategies. Ricky, who runs kawabonka.com, is versatile with all weapons, while JBI aka Chief has a 'take no prisoners' attitude. Strider is the silent sniper, CyAnide, the elite-speak techie and Fragbait is the wisecracking smart guy. Individually they are powerful, but as a team they're invincible.

The TUA is a generation weaned on Ataris and Spectrums. They know their PCs like the back of their hands and their gaming arsenal includes special configurations, binds, over-clocked PCs, and gaming mice and they are passionate about graphics cards and bandwidth. As far as their game is concerned, Mad_Toothbrush says, "It's practice, practice and more practice. Nothing is easy."

TUA is all set to take the step from being an elite clan to pro-gaming. World Cyber Games, the gaming Olympics, will begin in Korea in December 2001, and TUA will be there to find out where they stand. Wile is optimistic about their chances: "We've been watching and studying matches played at most large international meets. I have played in Singapore, and feel that we do match standards favourably." Right now TUA is busy getting more proficient in CS and preparing to take part in the Games. "The future's bright, the future's definitely not orange," quips Mad_Toothbrush. Way to go, TUA! 🍌

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The Unholy Alliance:
(L to R) CyAnide,
Strider, Wile, JBI,
Fragbait,
Mad_Toothbrush



Alliance. To the FPS clique at Kawabonka, they are gods.

TUA started off as a UT CTF/DM (*Unreal Tournament* Capture the Flag /Deathmatch) clan on Kawabonka.com in late 2000 when Kawabon-

ka.com was only a few months old and UT was the game to play. The name 'The Unholy Alliance' was suggested by CyAnide, a TUA member and picked from an old strategy game called *Dominus*—"Deep within the craggy mountains of Kplithor, an Unholy Alliance was forged...."

Seeing them dominating the UT CTF scene